Investigation report

Which advertising campaign caused each user’s purchase?

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Data

Authorized PocketToons SQLite
All observed successful charges, April–September 2026 UTC

Snapshot

Declared 2026-09-30 23:59:59 UTC
Build 3a0dbed21d2f45958aefa2887a0cadd8

Run

Independent
2026-11-09
11 query attempts; 10 successful

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How to read this report

- Check numbers refer to the individual JSONL evidence files.
- A recorded acquisition source is a first-touch channel, not a campaign or proof of causation.

Terms used in this report

Term	Meaning
Purchase	A valid, successful positive non-refund charge; includes subscription renewals and PPV. A later refund does not undo the charge count.
Snapshot	The declared user snapshot instant; it is not a verified database hash.

01. Chapter

The answer

01

The campaign that caused each purchase cannot be identified from this database. No campaign-to-user exposure or click link is recorded, and observational attribution alone would not prove causation (checks 4, 6, 10).

- The data contains **6,215 valid successful charges by 1,465 users**, including renewals; no campaign assignment is supported for any of these purchases (checks 7–8, 11).
- The recorded first-touch sources are organic 3,023 charges, paid search 1,649, paid social 1,484 and unknown 59. These are descriptive user-level source labels, not purchase-level campaign attribution (check 7).

02. Chapter

How we investigated

02

What data we used

- Independent investigation; no question-specific guides or answer keys were read. The supplied SQLite database was queried read-only.
- All available successful charges, effective 2026-04-01 01:00:00 through 2026-09-25 10:00:00 UTC inclusive; no comparison period was requested (check 8).
- Declared user snapshot: 2026-09-30 23:59:59 UTC. Build 3a0dbed21d2f45958aefa2887a0cadd8 succeeded 2026-11-09 11:16:56 UTC; build reconciliation checks are recorded as passing (checks 2–3).
- Revenue group v1.1 defines valid success and charge timing. Counts are an ad hoc descriptive application, not a registered campaign attribution metric.

Investigation path

- Inventory layers and build, inspect source schemas and event property keys, then quantify purchases and missing links.
- Gold marketing is channel-month only. Silver provides validated purchase and profile detail; Bronze supplies source schemas and event properties. Stop: a campaign-level link and causal design are absent.

03. Chapter

What happened

03

The movement

First-touch source	Charges	Distinct purchasers
Organic	3,023	700
Paid search	1,649	388
Paid social	1,484	363
Unknown	59	14
Total	6,215	1,465

- Sources partition users in this snapshot. Counts describe acquisition labels, not campaigns responsible for purchases (check 7).

04. Chapter

Why it happened

04

Hypothesis	Status	Evidence
Individual campaign links exist	Rejected for available schema	No campaign or UTM columns found; event JSON keys contain no campaign identifier (checks 6, 10).
First-touch source identifies the causing campaign	Inconclusive	Channel is not a campaign and cannot establish causation (checks 4, 7).

05. Chapter

Data quality and limits

05

Data quality

- 59 charges and 14 purchasers have unknown first-touch source. All 6,215 charge rows have user IDs; 4,546 lack checkout links and 4,490 lack session links. Off-session payments and uncaptured links have different meanings; neither count alone measures campaign coverage (checks 7–8).
- Thirteen payment rows have reviewed source-amount corrections; review time is unknown (check 9).
- The current repository registry SHA-256 differs from the registry SHA recorded at build. The builder SHA matches. Build-time reconciliation is historical; source fingerprints have not been independently recomputed, so current layer freshness is not verified.

Limitations

- There is no campaign identifier, user-level ad exposure or click-to-purchase mapping in the inspected schema and event properties. The absence of these fields prevents campaign assignment, irrespective of the share with a known channel.
- Even a linked click would support an agreed attribution rule, not by itself prove incremental causal impact.
- The supplied directory has no Git metadata; commit and download date are unavailable. Repository inspected 2026-11-09; hashes are recorded in run-notes.

06. Chapter

What to do next

06

01 Capture consent-appropriate campaign IDs and impression/click events with timestamps, stable identity linkage and purchase IDs; measure missing and ambiguous links.

02 Agree on the eligible purchases, attribution window, touchpoint precedence and treatment of renewals and unknowns before producing campaign attribution.

03 Use randomized holdouts or a defensible experiment to estimate incremental campaign effects, rather than treating assigned credit as causation.

Appendix

Evidence appendix

A

- Checks 01–11 are separate evidence logs; check 05 failed authorization on a table-valued PRAGMA and is retained. Check 10 used sqlite_master as a read-only alternative. All successful result sets were untruncated.
- Inputs, SQL, results, build reconciliation and an index are saved beside this report.